

William Frank Mahunda

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SUMMARY

Computer Science student and fintech startup founder building AI products end to end — from user discovery and go-to-market to RAG pipelines, agentic systems, and computer vision. Raised UNDP seed capital, shipped 10+ AI applications, and completed product and AI programs with AI4ALL, CodePath, Goldman Sachs, and McKinsey. Seeking Summer 2027 internships in product management and AI/software engineering.

EDUCATION

Alfred University — Computer Science

Aug. 2025 – May 2029

Presidential Scholarship

Alfred, New York

- Relevant coursework: Data Structures & Algorithms (Computer Programming I & II), AI for Computer Vision

EXPERIENCE

AI4ALL Ignite Fellow

Jun. 2026 – Aug. 2026

AI4ALL (ai-4-all.org)

Remote

- Selected for AI4ALL Ignite, a national accelerator for emerging AI leaders; built a machine learning model with a 7-person team predicting jet engine remaining useful life (RUL) on the NASA Turbofan (CMAPSS) dataset, enabling predictive maintenance that reduces downtime and improves flight safety.
- Applied Random Forest and Logistic Regression to multi-sensor degradation data; addressed dataset bias through sub-group performance analysis and cross-validation across engine types — pairing responsible AI practice with communicating tradeoffs to non-technical audiences.

Startup Founder

May 2024 – Aug. 2025

Kibenki (kibenki.com)

Zanzibar, Tanzania

- Founded a fintech startup providing emergency liquidity and financial access to SME workers in Tanzania excluded from traditional credit markets; owned product vision, user research, and roadmap end to end.
- Raised 4,000,000 TZS in seed capital from UNDP; secured venture-building support from Starthub Africa and the Funguo Program (UNDP, EU, UK Aid) through investor pitches and stakeholder management.
- Led regulatory compliance, business formalization, and tax strategy with the Tanzania Startup Association, coordinating legal, financial, and operational stakeholders.

Applied AI Engineering Fellow

Mar. 2025 – May 2025

CodePath

Remote

- Engineered 7 production-ready AI applications across 5 modules using Claude (Anthropic) and OpenAI APIs, RAG pipelines, and agentic workflows — completing 100% of program milestones with testing and documentation best practices.
- Architected human-in-the-loop AI systems with safety guardrails and risk-aware decision logic, reducing failure surface area in high-stakes automated workflows.
- Key projects: DocuBot (RAG document Q&A with vector search and embeddings), BugHound (agentic debugging assistant), PawPal (AI pet care management), Game Glitch Investigator (LLM-based fault diagnosis).

AI & Computer Vision Engineer

Jan. 2025 – May 2025

Alfred University — AI for Computer Vision

Alfred, New York

- Built and deployed a YOLOv8 + DeepSort real-time multi-person tracking pipeline achieving 80% detection accuracy with persistent identity tracking across full-length video, applying deep learning, CNNs, and data annotation/augmentation pipelines.

Software Engineering Apprentice

July 2024 – Oct. 2024

Headstarter AI

New York, NY (Hybrid)

- Built AI product development skills under direct mentorship from Y Combinator-backed founders who collectively raised \$50M+, working in Agile sprints.
- Led go-to-market strategy for a personal project — acquired 1,000+ waitlist users and generated \$1,000 in early revenue within weeks, validating product-market fit through audience targeting and waitlist funnels.

Program Manager & Co-Founder

Jan. 2025 – July 2025

The Kajengwa Project

Makunduchi, Zanzibar

- Designed and managed a 6-month technology literacy program serving 50+ underserved youth across 5 curriculum tracks (Python, Scratch, graphic design, digital marketing, entrepreneurship); mobilized a 100% donor-funded budget through partnerships with 3+ organizations.

PROJECTS

Vantage AI | github.com/William-franklyn/vantage | Python, LLM APIs

- AI-powered platform built for a financial advisory firm — designed and implemented end to end, from client needs and product concept to working software, applying LLMs to financial services workflows.

Workbox | github.com/William-franklyn/workbox | Full-stack

- Productivity/workflow application designed and shipped independently, covering frontend, backend, and product decisions across the full development lifecycle.

Real-Time Person Tracking | github.com/William-franklyn/real-time-person-tracking | Python, YOLOv8, DeepSort, OpenCV, FFmpeg

- AI tracking model for autonomous robotic systems that identifies and follows a designated individual in real time with persistent IDs, annotated video output, and live FPS overlay.

Data Visualization Library | github.com/William-franklyn/data-visualization-library | JavaScript

- Open-source, beginner-friendly JavaScript charting library — designed a public API, wrote documentation, and published for community use.

AI Music Recommendation System | github.com/William-franklyn/Music-recommendation-system-with-AI | Python, ML

- Preference-modeling recommendation engine that personalizes music suggestions based on user taste profiles.

CIFAR-10 Image Classifier | github.com/William-franklyn/cifar_10_machine_learning_project | Python, CNNs

- Convolutional neural network trained on the CIFAR-10 dataset, covering data preprocessing, model training, and evaluation.

LEADERSHIP & PROGRAMS

- **Goldman Sachs Possibilities Series** — competitively selected; workshops in investment banking, asset management, and financial technology (Spring 2026).
- **McKinsey Forward Scholar** — structured problem-solving, data-driven decision making, and executive communication (2024).
- **Aspire Leadership Fellow** — Harvard faculty-led program; delivered a community impact project; network of 1,000+ professionals (2024).

HONORS & AWARDS

- Best Innovative Student of the Year — recognized for outstanding innovation in academic and project work.
- Top 5 Hackathon Winner — Best Fresh Innovative Project in Health Tech (2023).
- Top 10 Young Innovators in Tanzania — EAC Innovator SprintUp Program.

TECHNICAL & PRODUCT SKILLS

Languages: Python, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, SQL

AI & ML: LLMs (Claude API, OpenAI API), RAG, Vector Search, Embeddings, Agentic AI, LangChain, Prompt Engineering, Machine Learning, Deep Learning, Computer Vision, CNNs, Human-in-the-Loop Systems, Responsible AI

Engineering: React, Node.js, REST APIs, OpenCV, YOLOv8, MongoDB, MySQL, Git/GitHub, CI/CD, Testing, Agile/Scrum

Product & Business: Product Discovery, User Research, Roadmapping, Go-to-Market Strategy, Customer Acquisition, Stakeholder Management, Capital Raising, Regulatory Compliance, Executive Communication